

THE
PROTEIN
GUIDEBOOK

SIMPLE · SCIENTIFIC · SUSTAINABLE

BY

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PROTEIN GUIDEBOOK

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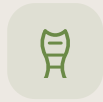
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CHAPTER 01

Why Protein Matters



01

Builds & Repairs

Rebuilds cells, skin, hair, muscles, and immune cells — the body's primary construction material.



02

Hormone Regulation

Regulates hormones and stabilizes blood sugar — foundational for sustained energy and mood.



03

Weight Management

Keeps you satiated, reduces cravings, and supports a healthy metabolism for sustainable weight control.



04

Liver Detoxification

Powers the liver enzymes essential for filtering toxins — no protein, no detox.

CHAPTER 02

Thermic Effect of Protein

PROTEIN

20–30%

Burns most

CARBS

5–10%

Moderate

FAT

0–3%

Minimal

Every time you eat protein, your body **burns 20–30% of its own calories just to digest it**. This is the thermic effect of food (TEF) — and protein leads carbs and fat by a wide margin. It's one of the reasons high-protein diets support fat loss without cutting calories drastically.



PRACTICAL TIP

Want to boost your metabolism? **Prioritize protein in your first meal after waking.** Your metabolic rate is most responsive in the morning — make protein the anchor of breakfast.

CHAPTER 03

Amino Acid Balance

Complete vs Incomplete — and how Indian food traditions already solve this.

COMPLETE

All 9 Essential Amino Acids

Contains every amino acid your body cannot synthesize on its own.

Eggs

Fish

Paneer

Soy

Chicken



INCOMPLETE

Missing 1-2 Amino Acids

Still nutritious — needs a partner food to complete the amino acid profile.

Dal

Rice

Wheat

Corn

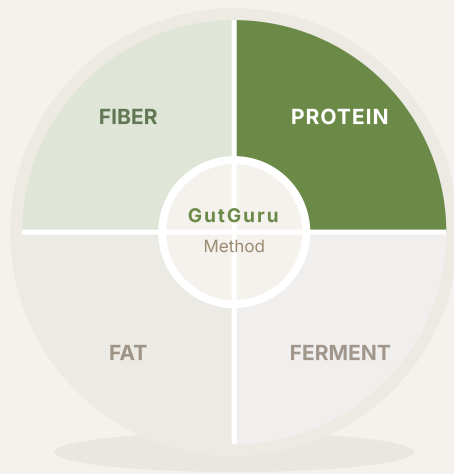


Dal chawal · roti + chana · idli + sambar — traditional Indian combinations are nutritionally complete.

CHAPTER 04

Protein Plate Formula

THE GUTGURU METHOD

**1 × Protein**

Dal, paneer, eggs, chicken, soy

+

**1 × Fiber**

Sabzi, salad, whole grains

+

**1 × Fat**

Ghee, coconut oil, nuts, seeds

+

**1 × Ferment**

Curd, achar, buttermilk, kanji

EXAMPLE MEAL

Moong Dal + Rice + Ghee + Curd**0.8–1.2_g**

per kg of body weight / day

DAILY PROTEIN TARGET

CHAPTER 05

Common Indian Protein Mistakes

**Skipping dals at dinner**

Dal is one of the most bioavailable plant proteins available. Removing it from dinner leaves a protein gap most people don't compensate for.

**Eating only carbs for breakfast**

Plain toast, upma, or biscuits spike blood sugar with no satiety. Starting with protein anchors energy levels and reduces mid-morning cravings.

**Depending only on supplements**

Whole food protein comes with fibre, micronutrients, and co-factors that powders do not replicate. Supplements supplement — they don't replace.

**Assuming vegetarians can't meet protein needs**

Dal, paneer, soy, curd, and chana — a well-structured vegetarian plate can comfortably hit 1g per kg daily.

**Avoiding ghee and healthy fats**

Dietary fats help absorb fat-soluble vitamins and support the hormones that regulate protein synthesis and muscle repair.

CHAPTER 06

Quick Myth Busters

MYTH Too much protein causes kidney damage.

TRUTH **Only applies to people with existing kidney disease.** For healthy individuals, dietary protein is processed normally. Your kidneys are designed to handle routine protein loads without strain.

MYTH You need protein powder to build muscle.

TRUTH **Whole food protein + resistance exercise is enough for most people.** Dal, eggs, paneer, and curd can meet muscle-building needs — without a single scoop of powder.

MYTH Eating protein at night will make you gain fat.

TRUTH **Total daily protein — not timing — determines body composition.** Protein at night actually supports muscle repair while you sleep, when recovery hormones are highest.

TAKE THIS HOME

Your 3 Quick Wins

Three specific actions you can start this week — no equipment, no cost, measurable results.

1

Add Protein to Your Breakfast Today

From tomorrow, **start every day with a protein source** — eggs, moong dal cheela, or chana salad before 9am. This anchors your blood sugar for the entire day and reduces afternoon cravings within 3 days.

START TOMORROW MORNING

2

Eat Your Protein Before Your Carbohydrate at Every Meal

At your next 3 meals, **eat dal, paneer, or egg first — then rice or roti**. This sequence measurably reduces the glucose spike of the entire meal. Notice the difference in energy and hunger within 2 days.

AT EVERY MEAL, STARTING TODAY

3

Calculate Your Daily Target and Track for 3 Days

Your target: body weight (kg) × 0.8–1.2 = grams of protein per day. Track what you actually eat for 3 days. Most people discover they are hitting less than 50% of their target — which explains fatigue, cravings, and slow recovery.

THIS WEEK — 3 DAYS

MORE AT www.thegutguru.co.in →



READY TO PERSONALIZE?

Book a 1-on-1 Consultation

Personalize your protein and gut health journey with a plan built specifically for your body, conditions, and lifestyle.

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Book Your Session →



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